Damir Kovač

Senior Frontend Engineer · Team Lead · React, TypeScript, Next.js

Zagreb, Croatia (EU citizen) · Remote (CET −6 to +3 hours), hybrid or on-site

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SUMMARY

Senior frontend engineer and team lead with 12+ years of experience. I deliver products end to end: planning, architecture and UI, backend, testing, CI/CD, releases and documentation. I join early or midway, lead and mentor the team, and take on "unsolvable" problems. Since 2025 I have been building with AI coding agents, and I keep getting faster.

SELECTED RECENT IMPACT

- Cut **exercise creation from a full day to under a minute** with AI coding agents.
- Co-created a pipeline that cut pull-request-to-live time **from 3–5 hours to 15 minutes**.
- Wrote a reusable graphing library as the sole developer, **saving a client $6–10k a month**.
- Revived a stalled platform by fixing tech debt, not "lack of manpower", and **led 5 people to production**.
- Launched a search Web Component, **adopted by over a dozen hotels**.
- Shipped a self-service styling tool, so hotels restyle their Web Components themselves, **ending 10+ error-prone manual database edits a week**.

SKILLS

- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, TanStack Query, Zustand, Redux, React Hook Form, Zod, performance optimisation
- **Backend:** Node.js, .NET / C# (Clean Architecture, Entity Framework Core), REST and OpenAPI, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, query performance
- **AI-assisted development:** Claude Code, parallel agents in worktrees, subagents, hooks, browser checks
- **Quality and delivery:** Playwright, Jest, React Testing Library, Sentry, PostHog, ESLint, SonarQube, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Cloudflare
- **UI:** design systems, Storybook, Figma, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui (Radix UI), React Aria, Material UI
- **Data visualisation:** ECharts, JointJS, Recharts, KaTeX, MathLive
- **Embedding and translations:** Web Components, multilingual UIs (next-intl, i18next), RTL layout
- **Leadership:** leading teams, hiring, daily PR reviews, code standards, mentoring

RECENT EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, LuqaLearn, Remote *06/2025 – 10/2026*

Next.js · TypeScript · Node.js · Tailwind · shadcn/ui · Zustand · Recharts · KaTeX · MathLive · PostHog · i18next · .NET (Clean Architecture, Entity Framework Core) · OpenAPI · PostgreSQL · Playwright · Jest · GitHub Actions · Dokku · Cloudflare

- Led development of a maths-learning platform with the founder, including daily full-stack PR reviews.
- Developed **the personalised practice flow, the core of the app**, in React and .NET.
- Automated content production with agent skills, taking guided exercises **from 3 days to under half a day**.
- **Fixed a 6-hour CI hang**, made end-to-end tests reliable and shipped major releases blue-green.
- Added the first product analytics, which **gave the team insight into what users want**.

Frontend Engineer, Turneo, Zagreb, on-site *01/2025 – 06/2025*

React · Next.js · Node.js · Vite · Web Components · TanStack Query · React Hook Form · Zod · Sentry · Storybook · Figma

- Early engineer at a startup whose software serves hotels such as Falkensteiner, Maistra and Royal Dubrovnik and their concierges, as well as booking companies and guests.
- Reduced the booking Web Components' **load time and bundle size**.
- Designed and implemented **Web Component styling across the whole stack**, for one or many components on one or many sites, shipped in steps, each live on the next page load.
- Removed long-running bugs that corrupted booking data and often reached users first, making the system stable, reducing maintenance and **giving users the experience they expected**.
- Started and led **the product's first design system**, from Figma through Storybook to the live product.

Senior Frontend Engineer, Martian & Machine, Remote *08/2024 – 11/2024*

Next.js · TypeScript · Node.js · shadcn/ui (Radix UI) · React Aria · translations (next-intl) · React Hook Form · Zod · pnpm · ESLint · SonarQube · GitLab CI

- **First frontend engineer** on a national smart-city platform in the Middle East (Saudi Arabia).
- Set up the project from zero, **a foundation the team kept after I left**.
- Delivered the MVP in English and Arabic, with suitable fonts and left- and right-to-left (RTL) layouts.
- Implemented certification and account management for the platform's first release.

Senior Frontend Engineer, Atomic Intelligence, Zagreb, on-site *06/2022 – 01/2024*

React · ECharts · JointJS · Material UI · Redux Toolkit · React Testing Library

- Planned the data platform refactor in phases, sped it up and mentored the team through it.
- Created a graphing library with features no competing tool offered, which **paid for itself many times over**.
- Single-handedly prototyped a music visualisation for an ML product, **cutting the estimate to a third**.
- Screened 50+ applicants, interviewed 20+ and **selected 2 developers to replace me long term**.

Frontend Engineer, 7o and Tellus, Zagreb, hybrid *05/2019 – 05/2022*

React · data visualisation

- Sole frontend engineer for a network security system that processes **terabytes of traffic a day**.
- Gave analysts views to filter and explore up to hundreds of thousands of detected threats.
- Proposed new visualisations from prospective clients' feedback and **linked alerts to analytics**, so analysts could see the whole situation on one screen.

Earlier Experience

Full-stack developer at Neoinfo, where within a year and a half I rose to lead developer of a 5-person team, reworked the platform to handle 3× the data with a 40% smaller team and became the Italian partner's main technical contact for the whole project. Frontend developer at Snowfall: automated end-to-end tests for 90+ versions of a payment portal, then moved with several colleagues to another project to meet a tight deadline on a tablet app (Ionic, Cordova). Frontend developer at TEB Informatika, where I led a team of four for Hrvatske ceste. Tutor in maths, physics and several programming languages for 500+ pupils and students.

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

- MSc in Information and Communication Technology and BSc in Computing, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER), University of Zagreb
- Languages: Croatian (native) · English (C1–C2) · Spanish (A1) · Serbian, Bosnian and Slovenian (B1)